

Text-Guided Visual Selection

Q: Which image could be associated with an Iranian folk dance accompanied by folk songs such as “Rana,” “Gol-e Pamchal,” or “Katouli”?



Q: What is the purpose of storytelling and reading Hafez fortunes during Yalda Night?

A: They create a warm family gathering in which older family members pass down stories, memories, moral lessons, and elements of Persian oral history to younger generations. Reading Hafez also connects the celebration to Persian poetry and literary tradition. Together, these practices help preserve cultural identity, encourage intergenerational communication, and strengthen family bonds.

Q: Why do Iranians apologize to the person behind them when they sit down in a taxi or bus?

A: Iranians may do this as a sign of politeness and taarof. By apologizing, they show respect for the other person's space, comfort, and presence, even if they have not actually done anything wrong.

Visual-to-Cultural Description



- Likely Subject:** Khaju Bridge, Isfahan
- Subject Category:** Historical Iranian architecture
- Cultural Region:** Isfahan, Iran
- Cultural relevance:** A major Safavid-era landmark and symbol of Isfahan's architectural heritage.
- Visual Evidence:** Repeated brick arches, central pavilion, water reflection, and historic bridge structure.



- Likely Subject:** Polo players on horseback (Chogan)
- Subject Category:** Traditional sport / Equestrian game
- Cultural Region:** Iran / Persian cultural heritage
- Cultural Relevance:** Chogan has deep roots in Iranian culture and was traditionally played by nobles and warriors
- Visual Evidence:** Shows riders on horses holding long mallets and competing for a ball on a field, which matches the visual features of polo or chogan.



- Likely Subject:** Persian sweets (Nokhodchi)
- Subject Category:** Traditional dessert
- Cultural Region:** Iran / Qazvin food culture
- Cultural Relevance:** Hospitality and festive gatherings
- Visual Evidence:** Square pieces, pistachio-like green texture

Q: In the tradition of Rumi and Sama, what does the whirling of the dervish mainly symbolize?

- A** A display of physical skill during public celebrations
- B** The soul's movement toward divine love, self-transcendence, and truth ☒
- C** A military exercise for group coordination

Q: What is usually done to prepare Fesenjan?

- A** Walnuts are ground and cooked with pomegranate paste ☒
- B** Eggplants are fried
- C** Yogurt and honey are added